

Future Together: Tumbarumba Community Event



Event Plan — The Future is Arriving. Is Tumbarumba Ready?

Working document · Prepared for Laura and Tumbarumba Chamber of Commerce

Event Overview

TITLE	The Future is Arriving. Is Tumbarumba Ready?
SUBTITLE	A free community talk on AI, work, and what’s coming next for our region
PRESENTER	Charlie Garrison, Future Together
SUPPORTED BY	Tumbarumba Chamber of Commerce
VENUE	Café Nest Cinema, Tumbarumba
DATE	Thursday 11 June 2026
DOORS OPEN	6:00 pm
TALK STARTS	6:30 pm
ESTIMATED FINISH	7:45–8:00 pm
ENTRY	Free
CAPACITY	30+ (cinema theatre seating)
REGISTRATION	Encouraged but not required — via futuretogether.community

Our Purpose

Why We’re Doing This

Something significant is happening, and most people in Tumbarumba — like most people everywhere — don’t yet have a clear picture of it. The technology reshaping how we work, run businesses, and organise our lives is moving faster than public awareness. That gap between what’s actually happening and what most people understand is the problem this event exists to close.

This isn’t an abstract concern. Rural and regional communities face particular exposure — fewer alternative employers, longer distances to services, tighter margins in business. But they also hold real strengths: existing community bonds, local institutions that still function, and people who know how to look out for each other.

Tumbarumba has something else too. After a decade of campaigning, this community has just won back its local council. That outcome — achieved through sustained, organised civic effort — is a reminder of what’s possible when a community decides to act together. A new council starting fresh is also a genuine opportunity: to shape local priorities, ask new questions, and ensure the community’s voice is heard in decisions that will define the next decade.

Future Together, the Tumbarumba Chamber of Commerce, and Café Nest are hosting this event because this community deserves the chance to face what’s coming together — informed, connected, and with a sense of agency rather than anxiety. **Not panic. Not paralysis. A conversation that leads to action.**

What We Want to Achieve

ON THE NIGHT

Thirty people leave better informed and less alone with their concerns. The questions raised during Q&A are ones people have been carrying privately — and the room discovers they’re not alone in asking them. The conversation continues at the café bar after the formal close.

IN THE WEEKS THAT FOLLOW

A cohort of engaged locals who want to keep meeting — the foundation for an ongoing community group. Chamber members and community leaders see the value in continuing to convene these conversations. Other local organisations (Rotary, schools, sporting clubs) adopt the template.

FOR THE NEW COUNCIL

Local councillors are aware that their community is thinking about these issues. Future Together provides a non-partisan, civic-minded space for that conversation to mature into policy interest and local action.

FOR THE REGION

Nearby communities — Tumut, Batlow, Rosewood, Walwa, Corryong, and Khancoban — hear what Tumbarumba did and want their own conversation. The Snowy Valleys region develops a reputation as a place that takes its future seriously.

FOR RURAL AUSTRALIA

The Tumbarumba event becomes a model that any community can follow — proof that a small regional town can engage seriously with one of the defining issues of our time, without waiting for someone else to start the conversation.

What Success Looks Like

- ✓ The room is full, or close to it
- ✓ At least 10 people sign up to stay connected or attend a future event
- ✓ At least one person says: *“I had no idea — I’m glad someone is talking about this”*
- ✓ Chamber members and community leaders want to co-host the next event
- ✓ A follow-up event is planned within three months — and this time, it fills a bigger room

Run Sheet

Time	What's Happening
6:00 pm	Doors open. Café bar available. Guests arriving and settling.
6:30 pm	Welcome by Tumbarumba Chamber of Commerce representative (2–3 min)
6:33 pm	Introduction of Charlie Garrison by Laura or Chamber rep (1–2 min)
6:35 pm	Talk begins — Charlie presents (approx. 45 min)
7:20 pm	Q&A — moderated by Charlie (approx. 20 min)
7:40 pm	Closing remarks — Charlie (2–3 min): what's next, how to stay connected
7:43 pm	Informal conversation continues — café bar available
8:00 pm	Venue close (or as agreed with Laura)

Talk Structure

The presentation uses a slideshow adapted from the existing Future Together meetup format — estimated 15 slides, 45 minutes. This is **a public talk with Q&A**, not an intimate group discussion.

#	Slide	Purpose	Time
1	Opening — Future Together intro, event framing	Set tone, welcome audience	2 min
2	The Timeline Has Collapsed — “10 years away is arriving in 1–3 years”	The core urgency hook	3 min
3	We Must Solve Alignment First — AI deception in controlled tests	The safety problem, grounded in evidence	3 min
4	The Singularity: A One-Way Door — recursive self-improvement	Why we can’t “undo” this	3 min
5	We Can’t Slow Down — race dynamics	Why pausing isn’t an option	2 min
6	What I’m Hearing — job impacts across sectors, robotics	Brings it to human scale; includes rural/regional angle	3 min
7	50/50: Utopia or Dystopia — split view	Honest framing: two real paths	3 min
8	Remember February 2020? — the analogy	Lands the “we’re in that phase now” point	3 min
9	Immediate Human Risks — jobs, food, purpose, welfare gap	What this means for ordinary life	4 min
10	What Does a Good Future Look Like? — personal + societal	Balances risk framing with genuine hope	3 min
11	Why Community Is the Answer — Awareness → Conversation → Action	Why we’re all in this room	3 min
12	Back to Basics — Maslow’s hierarchy	Grounding: what do we need to protect first?	3 min
13	What Can We Do? — 6 practical actions	Ends on action, not anxiety	4 min
14	The Bigger Picture — AI + climate + geopolitics + pandemic	Context: AI isn’t the only disruption	2 min
15	Resources & Close — QR codes, futuretogether.community, what’s next	CTA: join, register, share	2 min

Key Adaptations from the Conversation Format

- **Opening slide:** Remove “This is a discussion, not a presentation” framing. Brief welcome and event overview instead.

- **Discussion questions:** Transformed into rhetorical questions. Audience responds during Q&A, not mid-slide.
- **Slide 6:** Add a regional angle — what this means for rural communities and small towns like Tumbarumba.
- **Closing slide:** Replace Slack invite with in-person CTA: sign up to stay informed, register for the next event.
- **Maslow image:** Slide 12 references an image file — to be confirmed available at presentation time.

Technical & AV Requirements

Requirement	Detail	Status
Screen & sound	The theatre is an existing movie theatre — a screen and sound system are already in place.	⚠ Confirm screen size, projection setup, and laptop connections
Laptop connection	HDMI preferred. Charlie will bring Mac + appropriate adapter.	⚠ Confirm connector type
Microphone	Handheld or lapel mic strongly recommended for a theatre audience.	⚠ Confirm available or arrange to borrow one
Internet	Slideshow loads fonts from Google Fonts. WiFi preferred; phone hotspot available as fallback.	⚠ Confirm venue WiFi if available
Power point	For presenter's laptop at the front.	⚠ Confirm location
Lighting	Dim enough to see the screen; bright enough for audience comfort.	⚠ Discuss with Laura
Presenter laptop	Charlie will bring.	Charlie to bring

Room Setup

Element	Detail
Cinema access	Via inside the café — large room at the rear. Guests enter through the café.
Seating	Existing theatre seating (rows facing screen). ⚠ Confirm capacity — additional chairs may be needed if numbers are strong
Presenter position	Front of room, to the side of the screen so it remains visible to all seats
Welcome table	Small table at entry for optional sign-in, printed resources, and event leaflets
Signage	Future Together + Tumbarumba Chamber of Commerce logos at entry and on screen before talk starts
Café bar	Available from 6:00 pm (before talk) and from 7:43 pm (after) — guests encouraged to stay and talk

Registration & Door

- Guests encouraged to register in advance at **futuretogether.community** (not required)
- Registration provides a headcount and mailing list for future events
- At the door: simple sign-in sheet (name + email, optional) for walk-ins
- No ticket or ID required — just show up
- If capacity is reached: a sign on the door reading “Full tonight — scan for next event”

Promotion Plan

Channel	Detail	Owner
Local newspaper ad	Quarter-page and classified drafted — in progress: submitting now	Charlie / Chamber
Poster & flyer distribution	A4 posters to shop windows; A5 flyers for counters and noticeboards. Talking points sheet provided to each shopkeeper.	Charlie / Chamber
Chamber of Commerce	Member newsletter, member WhatsApp/email groups	Chamber
Café Nest	Posters up in café, flyers available for customers, word of mouth — Laura confirmed posters placed	Laura
Rotary Club	Contact in progress — framed as civic education event	Charlie
High school	Contact school — relevant for students and parents; most-impacted generation angle	Charlie
Bowling club	Contact in progress — noticeboard and word of mouth	Charlie
Other local groups	RSL, churches, sporting clubs — newsletters and noticeboards	Charlie
Facebook — local group	Post in Tumbarumba local Facebook group — primary social channel for this audience	Chamber / Laura
futuretogether.community	Event listed on website with registration link	Charlie

Questions for Laura

The following need Laura’s input before we can finalise the plan. Everything else is ready to go once a date is confirmed.

1. **Date** — confirmed: Thursday 11 June 2026 ✓
2. **AV** — what screen and projection setup is in the theatre? What laptop connections are available (HDMI? other)?
3. **Microphone** — is there a mic available, or can one be borrowed?
4. **Seating** — confirmed: 30+ ✓
5. **Café bar** — have the bar open from 6:00 pm (before) and again from around 7:45 pm (after)? ✓
6. **Timing** — is 6:00 pm doors / 6:30 pm start / 8:00 pm finish workable for the venue? ✓
7. **Anything else** — what would Laura want to know or flag that we haven't covered?

Next Steps

Step	Owner	When
Confirm date — ✓ Thursday 11 June 2026	Laura + Charlie	Done
Submit newspaper ad	Charlie + Chamber	In progress now
Distribute posters and flyers to shops	Charlie / Chamber	In progress now
Contact Rotary, high school, bowling club, other groups	Charlie	In progress now
Post in local Tumbarumba Facebook group	Chamber / Laura	In progress now
Confirm AV setup with Laura	Charlie + Laura	Needed before event
Adapt slideshow for public talk format	Charlie	Before event
Door sign-in sheet + QR code for joining Future Together	Charlie	Week of event
Printed resource list (optional)	Charlie	Week of event